

YUJIN ZHANG

CONTACT INFORMATION

Department of Political Science
Columbia University
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EDUCATION

Columbia University in the City of New York, NY 2019-2026 (Expected)
Ph.D., Political Science
• Fields: International Relations (Major), Comparative Politics
• Dissertation: Early-Life Experiences and Global Public Opinion on Economic Policymaking
• Dissertation Committee: Allison Carnegie (Co-Chair), Nikhar Gaikwad (Co-Chair), Junyan Jiang, Calvin Thrall
M. Phil., Political Science 2022
M.A., Political Science 2020
SAIS, Johns Hopkins University, Washington, D.C. 2018
M.A., International Political Economy and International Economics
Colorado State University, Fort Collins, CO 2016
B.A., magna cum laude, Business Administration
Hunan University, Changsha, Hunan, China 2014
B.A., Finance

RESEARCH INTEREST

Research Focus: International political economy, transformation of the international economic order, economic security and statecraft, political socialization
Regional Focus: East Asia, Developed Economies

PUBLICATION

Peer-Reviewed

- [2] 2026. “Inflation of Populism: Effects of Early Economic Experiences on Support for Populist Parties.” *Economics & Politics*, Early View.
– **Keywords:** Inflation, Populism, Early Experiences, Public Opinion, European Politics
- [1] 2024. “Political Trust and Government Performance in the Time of COVID-19.” *World Development* 176 (106499), with Chengyuan Ji and Junyan Jiang.
– **Keywords:** Health governance, political trust

Revise & Resubmit

- [2] “Assistance to Me, and to Thee: Early Inequality Experiences and Public Preferences for Overseas Aid.” R&R at *International Studies Quarterly*.
– **Keywords:** Foreign Aid, Inequality, Early Experiences, Public Opinion, Developed Countries
- [1] “Prosperity and Openness: Early Globalization Experiences and Mass Preferences for Free Trade.” R&R at *Comparative Political Studies*.
– **Keywords:** Formative experiences, trade preferences, East and Southeast Asia
– **Presentations:** APSA 2024, MPSA 2024

PAPER UNDER REVIEW

- [2] “Rethinking Backlash against Trade Openness: Import–Export Preferences in Two Dimensions” with Ziwen Zu.

- **Previous Title:** “Why Mercantilism? Preferences for Trade Surplus and Mercantilist Policies”
 - **Keywords:** Globalization Backlash, Mercantilism, Isolationism, Survey Experiment, United States and China
 - **Presentations:** APSA 2026, GSIPE-APSA 2026, ISA 2026, IPES 2025
- [1] “Collaborative Competition? The Efficiency-Risk Dilemma and Public Preferences for International Technological Transfer.” with Ziwen Zu.
- **Keywords:** Technological preferences; Economic Security; Geopolitical Competition; the United States; Survey experiment
 - **Presentations:** APSA 2026, ISA 2026, IPES 2025

WORKING PAPER

- [2] “[Partisan Responses to Economic Shocks: Inflation Crises and the Paradox of Trade Liberalization.](#)”
- **Keywords:** Inflation crisis, trade liberalization, political parties, electoral politics
 - **Presentations:** APSA 2025, MPSA 2025
- [1] “[Aversion to What?: Early-Life Economic Experiences and Responses to Inflation.](#)”
- **Keywords:** Formative experiences, macroeconomic attitudes, Europe
 - **Presentations:** APSA 2023

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

- [4] “Nationalist, United?”
- [3] “On Industrial Policies.”
- [2] “Environmental and Electoral Consequences of the Trade War.”
- [1] “Life Experiences and Attitudes toward Military Alliance.” with Allison Carnegie and Elizabeth Saunders.

POLICY PUBLICATION

- [1] 2018. “[China’s Coal-to-Gas Program: A Developing Environmental Governance Regime.](#)” *SAIS Review of International Affairs*.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Columbia University

Politics of International Economic Relations, Prof. Jeffrey Frieden	Fall 2024
Chinese Politics, Prof. Junyan Jiang	Fall 2021, Spring 2023
China’s Foreign Relations, Prof. Thomas Christensen	Spring 2021, Fall 2022, Spring 2025
International Politics, Prof. Alexander de la Paz	Spring 2022
Autocracy and Democracy, Prof. Timothy Frye	Fall 2020

SAIS, Johns Hopkins University

Advanced Topics in International Trade (Graduate), Prof. Hiau Looi Kee	Spring 2018
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RESEARCH ASSISTANCE

Columbia University

Prof. Nikhar Gaikwad	2022-25
Prof. Junyan Jiang	2021-23, 25

SAIS, Johns Hopkins University

Prof. Ling Chen	2017-19
Prof. David Steinberg	2018-19

FELLOWSHIPS, GRANTS, AND

AWARDS	External	
	Humane Studies Fellowship, Institute for Humane Studies (\$6500)	2024, 26

Finalist, NY/PANJ AAPOR Young Public Opinion Stars	2024, 26
Expense Support Grant, Institute for Humane Studies (\$7500)	2025
Travel Grant, Graduate Students in International Political Economy	2022
Travel Grant, International Studies Association	2019

Columbia University

C. Martin Wilbur Fellowship	2025-26
CPE Graduate Student Grant (\$7000)	2025-26
Dissertation Fellowship	2023-24
Travel Grant	2023-26
Teaching Fellowship	2020-23, 24
Weatherhead East Asian Institute Fellowship	2019-20

SAIS, Johns Hopkins University

SAIS Fellowship	2017-18
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Colorado State University

Dean's List	2014-15
Global Partnership Fellow	2014-16

CONFERENCES AND WORKSHOPS	2026: APSA $c,d \times 3, p \times 2$ $\diamond$ GSIPE-APSA Pre-Conference Workshop $\diamond$ ISA $c, p \times 2$ $\diamond$ IHS Trade Workshop
	2025: IPES $p \times 2$ $\diamond$ GSIPE d, p $\diamond$ MPSA d, p
	2024: Virtual International Political Economy Society $\diamond$ NY/PANJ AAPOR Young Public Opinion Stars $\diamond$ GSIPE Mini-Conference $\diamond$ GSIPE d, p $\diamond$ APSA $\diamond$ MPSA
	2023: Northeast Regional Workshop in European Politics $\diamond$ GSIPE d, p $\diamond$ APSA
	2022: GSIPE APSA Workshop
	2021: Political Science Speaker Series
	2019: ISA
	2018: MPSA

**c = Chair, d = Discussant, p = Paper*

SKILLS

Languages: Mandarin (Native)
Programming: R, Stata, L^AT_EX, Python, LLM API integration
Methods: Survey design, experiment design, conjoint analysis

SERVICE	Event Coordinator, Graduate Student in International Political Economy	2024-25
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REFeree	<i>Policy Studies / Social Science Research / World Development</i>
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE	The US-China Business Council	2018-19
	China Africa Research Initiative	2016-17, 2018-19
	The Woodrow Wilson International Center for Scholars	2018
	The Brookings Institution	2018

REFERENCES

Allison Carnegie

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Nikhar Gaikwad

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Calvin Thrall

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